STRONGMAN

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This program is designed to make you the strongest strongman possible. It covers the basics of preparation for the events you may find in competition. This is general strongman preparation, so if the competition you're preparing for in less than 6 weeks' time doesn't include log press or deadlift, but other events, you'll need to make them the priority of your preparation in terms of specificity. To find out how to optimize and articulate your personalized training, please refer to the “Do your own training” guide.

The vast majority of coaches these days are trying to attract a wider audience by making their workouts more accessible, notably by reducing the frequency to 3 or 4 days a week.

Another dimension that isn't often addressed, mainly because it doesn't concern bodybuilding or powerlifting, is the density of your training.

As a strongman, you'll need to be fast both inside and outside the set. In other words, not only do your reps as fast as possible, but also your entire workout. Many events are graded according to time, and in the competition itself you won't always be able to warm up as much as you'd like.

You're going to have to push yourself to get better. On all the exercises you'll be planning the performance you're aiming for at the end of the cycle, and all your training will be a gradual preparation towards that performance.

The indications I give you are general (written as a percentage of your 1rm with a range, start your workloads low and increase if you dare), if you want to be able to optimize your

programming, get “Make your own workout or optimize an existing one” available on lewitchere.com.

Week 1

Day 1
Log press (1 clean) 6x8 @60-70%
Deadlift 3x8 @65%
Overhead press (dumbbell) 2x40*

Day 2
Squat 1x4 @ 65-75%
Front squat 2x8 @rpe6-7
Push press 5x8 @rpe6
Sled push x2

Day 3
Incline (bench) 4x6 @rpe6-7 / superset pull-up @rpe9
Close grip incline 1x12 @rpe8
Yoke x2**
Chest supported row 3x40*

Day 4
Viper press / Axl press 3x3 @75% (every rep from the ground)
Front squat 3x4 @rpe6
Farmers x2*

Day 5
Strict log 5x12 @rpe6-7 / pull-up @rpe9
Deadlift farmers 2x4 @rpe7
High incline (dumbbell) 2x40*

Day 6
Circuit yoke / sandbag / farmers x3**

As you may have noticed, there are a few peculiarities in this program.

First of all, when I write 1x4, it means a series of 4 repetitions. When I write a specification in brackets, each time the exercise in question returns to the program it will always be performed as specified in the brackets, even if the brackets are no longer there (e.g. if I say (log press 1 clean and the next time is just written log press it's to be done with only 1 clean). In a superset, if I write series + repetitions only once, this means that it applies to both exercises.

* Yes, you read that right, these are series of 40. However! These long series are to be treated in a special way. Treat them as a challenge. You should aim for 40 repetitions. If you achieve this, it means you have to go heavier. If on the first day you choose a weight and end up doing only 30 reps with it, so much the better, you'll then try week after week to bring that load up to 40 reps, and when that's done, increase the load. All repetitions, even the first, should be performed with an explosive eccentric movement.

** For all carry-type exercises where the aim is to cover a distance with a load (farmer, yoke, etc.), I advise you to build up these exercises with each cycle. In other words, start with the first few sessions to lay the foundations, aiming solely for a certain distance or duration without worrying about speed, and then add to it gradually. How you progress with these exercises depends on when your next competition takes place.
As you will see, week 4 should be treated as a pivot week, when you start to lower the volume and increase the intensity (especially on the carries).

Week 2

Day 1
Log press 8x8 @60-70%
Deadlift 3x8 @65-67%
Overhead press 3x40

Day 2
Squat 1x4 @70-75%
Front squat 3x8 @rpe7
Push press 6x8 @rpe7-8
Sled push x2

Day 3
Incline (bench) 6x6 @rpe7 / superset pull-up @rpe9
Close grip incline 1x12 @rpe8
Yoke x2
Chest supported row 3x40

Day 4
Viper press / Axl press 75-80% 4x3
Front squat 3x4 @rpe7
Farmers x2

Day 5
Strict log 6x10 @rpe7 / pull-up @rpe9
Deadlift farmers 3x4 @rpe8
High incline 3x40

Day 6
Circuit yoke / sandbag / farmers x4

Week 3

Day 1
Log press 10x8 @60-70%
Deadlift 3x8 @65-70%
Overhead press 4x40

Day 2
Squat 1x4 @70-75%
Front squat 3x8 @rpe7
Push press 8x8 @rpe7-8
Sled push x2

Day 3
Incline (bench) 6x6 @rpe7 / superset pull-up
Close grip incline 1x12 @rpe8
Yoke x3
Chest supported row 3x40

Day 4
Viper press / Axl press 75-80% 5x3
Front squat 4x4 @rpe7
Farmers x3

Day 5
Strict log 8x8 @rpe7 / pull-up
Deadlift farmers 3x4 @rpe8
High incline 3x40

Day 6
Circuit yoke / sandbag / farmers x6

Week 4

Day 1
Log press 3x8 @55-60%
Deadlift 1x8 @65%
Overhead press 1x40

Day 2
Squat 1x4 @70%
Front squat 1x8 @rpe6
Push press 3x8 @rpe7
Sled push x1

Day 3
Incliné (bench) 2x6 @rpe7 / superset tractions
Close grip incliné 1x12 @rpe7
Yoke x1
Chest supported row 1x40

Day 4
Viper press / Axl press @75% 2x3
Front squat 4x4 @rpe7
Farmers x3

Day 5
Strict log 2x8 @rpe6 / tractions
Deadlift farmers 1x4 @rpe7
High incline 1x40

Day 6
Rest

Week 5

Day 1
Log press 3x4 @75-80@ + 1x7 @70%
Deadlift 1x3 @80% + 2x7 @70%
Overhead press 2x40

Day 2
Squat 1x4 @75%
Front squat 3x6 @70%
Push press 2x4@rpe7 + 2x7@rpe8
Sled push x2

Day 3
Incline (bench) 3x7@rpe8 / superset weighted pull-up
Close grip incline 1x12 @rpe9
Yoke x3
Chest supported row 3x40

Day 4
Viper press / Axl press @rpe8 4x3
Front squat 1x3 @rpe8 + 2x7@rpe9
Farmers x3

Day 5
Strict log 3x5@rpe8 / pull-up
Deadlift farmers 1x3@rpe9 + 1x7@rpe7
High incline 3x40

Day 6
Circuit yoke / sandbag / farmers x3

Week 6

Day 1
Log press 1x1 + 2x3@80-85%
Deadlift 1x1 + 1x3@80-85%
Overhead press 1x40

Day 2
Squat 1x3
Front squat 2x6 @rpe9
Push press 1x1 + 2x4 @rpe9
Sled push x1

Day 3
Incliné (bench) 2x4 @rpe9 / superset weighted pull-up
Close grip incline 1x7 @rpe10
Yoke x1
Chest supported row 2x40

Day 4
Viper press / Axl press 1x2 + 2x3 @rpe9
Front squat 1x3 + 1x7@rpe10
Farmers x1

Day 5
Strict log 1x3 + 1x7 @rpe9 / pull-up
Deadlift farmers 1x3
High incline 1x40

Day 6
Circuit yoke / sandbag / farmers x2